

Prompt Like a Banker

The 5-line prompt method for safe, review-ready AI work. Use this before a banker copies AI output into an email, checklist, memo, SOP, customer response, board item, examiner response, or retained record.

- 1 You are helping a [ROLE].
- 2 Use only [SOURCE].
- 3 Create [OUTPUT_FORMAT].
- 4 Do not invent facts, make decisions, expose data, or add unsupported claims.
- 5 Mark uncertain items as [VERIFY]. Label the output as draft for [REVIEWER].

CHOOSE THE WORK

Draft, summarize, rewrite, extract, compare, or checklist.

PROTECT THE DATA

Use placeholders before source material enters the prompt.

REVIEW BEFORE USE

AI drafts. A qualified human checks before use.

RULE

If the prompt asks AI to decide, approve, deny, file, send, publish, investigate, or retain final output, rewrite it. The prompt should ask for draft support and require human review.

Classify the data before writing the prompt.

Ask what data will enter the prompt and where it will be used. Public tools should not receive customer data, confidential bank information, SAR/BSA/AML details, fraud facts, credit decisions, examiner-sensitive content, legal conclusions, security details, credentials, or production access details.

**Green**

Public, published, synthetic, or internal non-sensitive work. Human review still required.

**Yellow**

Confidential or higher-risk work. Use approved tools and a named reviewer.

**Blocked**

Restricted data plus public or uncertain tool context. Route to approved workflow.

Use placeholders

[CUSTOMER]	[ACCOUNT_TYPE]	[ACCOUNT_NUMBER]
[DATE]	[AMOUNT]	[TRANSACTION_TYPE]
[BRANCH]	[PRODUCT]	[NEXT_STEP]
[POLICY_SECTION]	[REVIEWER]	[VERIFY]

**Placeholder warning**

Placeholders reduce exposure. They do not make sensitive facts automatically safe. If the story still reveals a real customer, SAR, fraud case, complaint, loan file, examiner issue, or security issue, escalate instead of prompting.

Bankers learn faster from examples.

UNSAFE

"Summarize John Smith's account issue and draft a response about why his debit card transaction was denied."

SAFE

"Using only the redacted facts below, draft a customer-service response template. Do not include account numbers, balances, transaction details, fraud conclusions, eligibility decisions, or promises. Mark missing facts as [VERIFY]. Label the output as draft pending banker review."

Required before copy or download

- ☐ Sensitive data removed or replaced with approved placeholders.
- ☐ Prompt asks for draft support, not a final decision.
- ☐ Uncertain items must be marked [VERIFY].
- ☐ Tool is approved for the data class.
- ☐ Output format is clear.
- ☐ Reviewer and escalation trigger are named.

Source basis: NIST AI Risk Management Framework, OWASP GenAI Top 10, Interagency Guidance on Third-Party Relationships, CFPB Regulation B, CFPB Regulation P, FFIEC BSA/AML Manual risk concepts, and AiBI safe-use/control-plane curriculum.

Adapt before adoption: This prompt card is a training and implementation aid, not legal advice or an examiner-approved policy. Adapt it to your institution's approved tools, data classifications, retention schedule, review authority, and escalation procedures.